IELTS TURBO · WEEK 1 · SAT 31 OCT 2026 · EDUCATION

Writing Task 2: opinion (agree or disagree)

> **Schoolteachers are more responsible for students' educational success than parents and other family members. Do you agree or disagree?**

Question: Dilshodbek Ravshanov (Band 9.0), Telegram, 5 Oct 2026 · https://t.me/ieltsaidbydilshodbek/8339

40 minutes · at least 250 words · typed on the computer. Plan for 5 minutes, write for 30, check for 5.

Your plan

Introduction	Paraphrase the question in one sentence. Then give your position clearly: agree, disagree, or partly agree.
Body 1	Your first and strongest reason. Explain it, then give one specific example.
Body 2	Your second reason, with an example from real life (your country, your school, a study).
Body 3 (optional)	The other side in one or two sentences, then show why your view is still stronger.
Conclusion	Repeat your position in new words. No new ideas.

Before you hand it in

- ☐ Your position is in the introduction AND the conclusion, and it is the same.
- ☐ Every body paragraph starts with one clear main idea.
- ☐ Each main idea has a specific example (a number, a country, a real situation).
- ☐ 250 words or more (aim for 270 to 300). Count on the computer.
- ☐ At least 5 phrases from the vocabulary table, used naturally.

Model answer

Written for this lesson · 310 words · the highlighted phrases are in the vocabulary table.

It is sometimes argued that schoolteachers **play a bigger role in** a child's **academic achievement** than parents or other relatives. While teachers clearly matter, I disagree with this view, because the family shapes a child's habits long before school begins and continues to support learning outside the classroom.

To begin with, **the foundations of learning are laid** at home. Children who grow up surrounded by books, conversation and curiosity tend to arrive at school with a wider vocabulary and a longer **attention span**. These early advantages are difficult for any teacher to recreate, since a teacher meets a child only after the most **formative years** have passed. Moreover, attitudes towards education are largely inherited: if parents treat homework as a priority and praise effort rather than talent, children are far more likely to **persevere** when lessons become **demanding**.

In addition, the time a teacher can give each pupil is severely limited. A typical class may contain thirty students, and a single teacher can **devote** only a few minutes to any one of them during a lesson. Parents, **by contrast**, can notice when their child is struggling, discuss the problem in the evening and arrange extra help, such as private tutoring or a language course. In my country, for instance, many families **invest a considerable share of** their income in after-school classes, which often **make the decisive difference** in entrance examinations.

Admittedly, an inspiring teacher can **transform a student's attitude to** a subject, and for children from difficult home backgrounds, school may be the only place where learning is valued. However, such cases show that teachers can **compensate for** a lack of family support, not that they are generally more influential.

In conclusion, although teachers contribute significantly to academic success, I believe parents and relatives **bear greater responsibility**, as they create the conditions in which learning either **thrives** or fails.

Authentic sample answer

Read the Band 9 sample by Dilshodbek Ravshanov (Band 9.0):
https://t.me/ieltsaidbydilshodbek/8339

Compare: which reasons did he choose? How did he give examples? Which of his phrases would you use?

Vocabulary from the model answer

PHRASE	MEANING	SIMILAR WORDS YOU CAN USE
play a bigger role in	be more important for	*have a greater influence on · be more decisive for · matter more to*
academic achievement	good results at school or university	*educational success · academic performance · progress at school*
the foundations of learning are laid	the first, most basic skills are built	*the groundwork is done · the basis is formed · learning begins*
attention span	how long you can concentrate	*concentration · focus · ability to stay on task*
formative years	early years that shape a person	*early childhood · the most important years of development*
persevere	keep trying when it is hard	*persist · keep going · not give up*
demanding	difficult, needs a lot of effort	*challenging · tough · intellectually hard*
devote (time) to	give time to	*dedicate · spend · allocate time to*
by contrast	on the other hand (shows a difference)	*in contrast · conversely · whereas*
invest a considerable share of	spend a large part of (money, time)	*spend a significant proportion of · put a lot of money into*
make the decisive difference	be the reason for success	*be the key factor · tip the balance · determine the result*
transform someone's attitude to	change how someone feels about	*reshape · completely change · turn around someone's view of*
compensate for	make up for something missing	*make up for · offset · fill the gap left by*
bear greater responsibility	be more responsible	*be more accountable · carry more of the burden*
thrive	grow and do very well	*flourish · prosper · succeed*

Notice in the authentic sample

PHRASE	MEANING	SIMILAR WORDS
parental involvement	parents taking part in a child's learning	*parents' participation · family support*
extracurricular activities	classes and clubs outside the school program	*after-school activities · out-of-school courses*
cognitive development	the growth of thinking skills	*intellectual development · mental growth*
a positive learning environment	a place that helps you learn	*a supportive atmosphere for study*
the school curriculum	everything a school officially teaches	*the syllabus · the school program*
guardians	adults legally caring for a child	*caregivers · carers*

Use it: write your own essay on the same question and use at least five of these phrases. Mark them in your text.